

THE UNIVERSAL HOUSE OF JUSTICE

1999-02-25

To all National Spiritual Assemblies dear b aháí f

1 The year 2000 will conclude the hundred years that ‘Abdu’l-b ahá de-
2 scribed as “the century of light.” his perspective on the twentieth century
3 offers bahá’ís and bahá’í communities an opportunity to participate mean-
4 ingfully in many of the activities and discussions expected to take place
5 around the world over the coming two years.
6 asked the bahá’í international community’s office of public information
7 to prepare the enclosed document, “ who is writing the future?” As you
8 will see, it both examines the events of the twentieth century in the light
9 of bahá’u’lláh’s Teachings, and relates these developments to the challenges
10 facing humanity at century’s end. its purpose is to serve as a source of ideas,
11 perspectives, images, and language that will stimulate a wide range of cre-ative
responses among b ahá’ís.291.4

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293 1996–2000 • T h e f o u r Y e a r P l a n

294 657The sponsorship of millennial activities will, of course, be the concern
295 of non-b ahá’í groups, but the house of justice believes that such activities
296 can be seen by bahá’ís and the bahá’í communities as creating occasions
297 whose effectiveness can be enhanced by bahá’í contributions. given the
298 great diversity of our community’s resources, National Spiritual Assemblies
299 will want to ensure that ample latitude is given for a wide range of responses
300 by individual believers and groups. Artists, writers, musicians and drama-

301 tists will no doubt find the enclosed document highly stimulating and will readily
identify ways in which its themes can be introduced into activities organized by government
agencies and various private bodies. it is likely that

302 programs of scholarly associations will also present a range of opportunities for
qualified believers to draw attention to bahá'í perspectives on the cur-

303 rent world situation. your Assembly may wish to address special messages

304 to groups in your own country, adapting elements of the document's theme to this
purpose.

in order that such efforts enjoy broad support within the bahá'í com-

305 munity, it will be important for the friends to understand the message being

communicated. consequently, consideration should be given to ways of

306 incorporating the material in the enclosed document into bahá'í summer

307 school programs and local study activities.

308 As you will note, " who is writing the future?" has been cast in the form

309 of a message addressed to non-b ahá'í readers. This has been done primarily

310 in order to make the material most readily useful to bahá'ís participating in

311 the various events marking the beginning of the new millennium. Should your
Assembly feel, however, that the document would also be useful as a

312 booklet or brochure, there is no objection to your publishing it. in that case,

313 although the design is left to your discretion, the text should be used in its present
form, without editing, commentary, or supplementary material.

whatever their various forms of belief, our fellow human beings are

314 looking to the immediate future with mingled feelings of tentative hope and deep
anxiety. This circumstance offers bahá'ís a unique opportunity to

315 share with them the Teachings that give meaning to this critical moment in

316 human history.

317 with loving bahá'í greetings,

for Department of the Secretariat

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293 message from The Universal House of Justice

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Appointment of Continental Counselor for Australasia

[signed: The Universal House of Justice]